

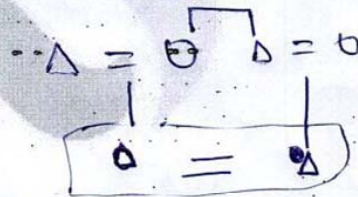
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- (c) Discuss different form of preferential marriages with examples from tribal societies in India. (15 marks)

Preferential marriages are the types of marriages that are 'preferred' in the society as they increase the social status. However, the punishment for violating preferential marriage is small that is loss of social prestige.

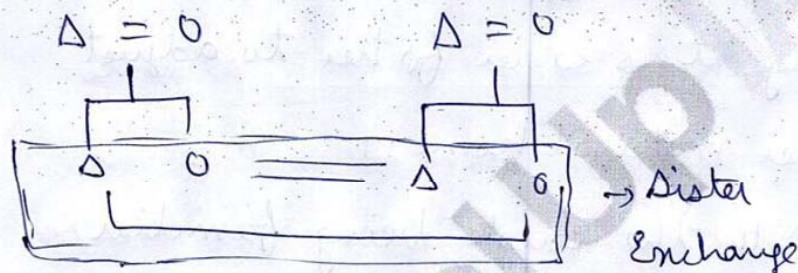
Forms of preferential marriages:

- (i) In many tribes and in South India, cross-cousin marriages are the most common type of preferential marriages.

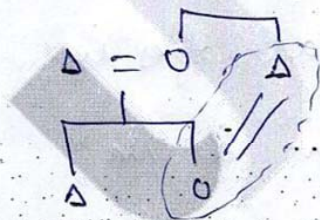


Eg. In Gonds, cross-cousin marriage is called 'dhudh-kutawa' where there is a balanced reciprocity across generations.

(ii) In Gonds, there is also a common preferential marriage system of sister exchange where balanced reciprocity occurs in the same generation.



(iii) In South India, a very unique and special form of preferential marriage occurs which is uncle-niece marriage.



For this to happen, the boy has to be way younger than his sister.

Reasons for preferential marriages

- (i) To protect property from going out of the family, usually preferential marriages are resorted to.
- (ii) Since the girl comes from same family, it is easier for her to adjust in her maternal home.
- (iii) With the couple being familiar with each other, there are lesser chances of conflicts in marital life.

Thus, there are many forms of preferential marriages in India especially seen in South India and tribes like Gonds etc.